Report from IRF Representatives
2014 AGM

The function of the New Zealand IRF reps is to debate and vote on proposals that arise during the year from member rogaining countries. Our two representatives are Nick Collins and Emma de Lacey (took over from Alan Holdaway early in 2013).

Here is a brief summary of the issues we have had input to in 2013:

- Bids to host WRC 2015
  - North Finland was the successful candidate over South Finland, Ukraine and Latvia.
- Bids to host WRC 2016
  - Australia was the successful candidate over South Finland, Ukraine and Latvia.
- Debate around rule changes arising from reports on WRC 2013
  - This was an energetic discussion with suggestions to regulate distance between controls and placement of water drops, amongst other things. No consensus was obtained!
- Rules for preferential entry to WRC 2014
  - As explained on the South Dakota website.
- Debate around a future financial model for the IRF
  - This included the NZRA deciding on how many "committed" rogainers there are in NZ (200-500 was our decision).
- A new Strategic Plan for the IRF, to be completed by mid-2014.
- Rotation Policy for WRCs, by geographic region (passed unanimously)- Divide the rogaining world into four regions:
  - Europe
  - North America
  - Australasia
  - Other–rest of the world

  Preference for WRC locations is rotated through the four regions with Europe allocated two WRCs and all other regions one WRC within each five-WRC period. Countries from the preferred region are given the first opportunity to submit expressions of interest each year.

- Hosting Policy for WRCs, that only member countries may supervise and be responsible for the holding of WRCs
  - Passed unanimously.

Emma de Lacey 16/02/14

IRF Technical Committee 2013/2014

Work on the IRF competition rules is ongoing. Most of the proposed changes are clarifications/rewording, alignment of IRF rules with current ARA rules (and thus NZRA rules), and to tidy up interpretations. Some outcomes, if the current draft is accepted, would be:

- To allow personal GPS trackers (no readout) and organiser's trackers; but no release of info during the event – so there wouldn't be spectator tracking.
- Allow swimming as well as travel on foot. OOB and no access rules apply.
- No assistance anywhere from map handout to event finish (previously just on the course), except for medical assistance. Includes admin area as well as course.
- After using mobile phones team must withdraw or be disqualified – our WRC2010 rule.
- Dumping packs – compulsory gear "should" be carried at all times. I suggested "must" to remove doubt.
- Any pre-existing maps, topo and event maps, to be notified in advance to all participants, e.g. our Cheviot HOW prior to WRC2010 would be in this category. Links to LINZ topo maps would be provided on the event website.

No other significant deviations from NZ rules have been proposed.

Other points:

1. A suggestion to change age groups to as at 1st January rather than the first day of the event seems to have died.
2. Discussion as to whether a team should be allowed (for example) to eat, rest/sleep in motel, have a shower during the event. European courses usually have facilities in villages on the course. How is assistance policed then? Ongoing – so far considered too difficult to formulate and police.
3. Australia (and thus NZ) and Russia are pushing for U20 to be replaced by U23. No resolution as yet.

Bill Kennedy, 16th February 2014